

RE: Appeal of Denied MRI Lumbar Spine

Patient: John Anderson

Member ID: HF-987654321

Claim Number: CLM-2026-45897

To: HealthFirst Insurance Appeals Department

I am writing to formally appeal the denial of MRI Lumbar Spine Without Contrast for the above referenced patient.

The denial states that medical necessity criteria were not met due to insufficient evidence of conservative treatment.

However, the medical record demonstrates:

1. Completion of Physical Therapy from January 5, 2026 through March 12, 2026.
2. Completion of Medication Therapy using Ibuprofen 800mg daily for eight weeks.
3. Completion of a Home Exercise Program for ten weeks.

Additionally, the patient continues to experience:

- Persistent lumbar pain for over four months
- Numbness and tingling in the right foot
- Reduced mobility
- Suspected lumbar radiculopathy

According to HealthFirst Policy MSK-2026-LSP Section 4.2, MRI coverage is appropriate when symptoms persist beyond six weeks, conservative treatment has failed, and neurological findings are present.

The patient satisfies all stated criteria.

Therefore, we respectfully request reconsideration and approval of the requested MRI.

Sincerely,

Dr. Sarah Mitchell Sunrise Orthopedic Clinic